

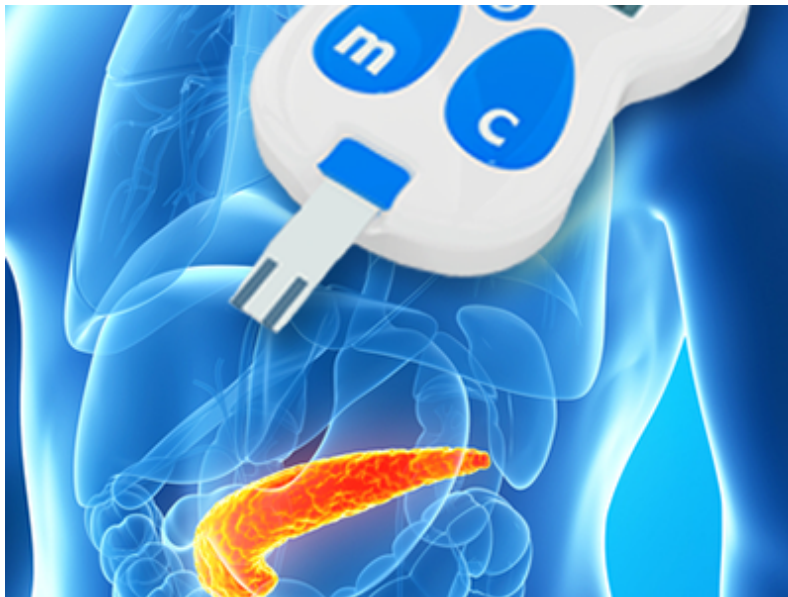


National Institute of
Diabetes and Digestive
and Kidney Diseases

Diabetes

Diabetes is a disease that occurs when your blood glucose, also called blood sugar, is too high. Over time, having too much glucose in your blood can cause other health problems such as heart disease, nerve damage, eye problems, and kidney disease. You can take steps to prevent or manage diabetes.

According to the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention's *National Diabetes Statistics Report*, an estimated 38.4 million people in the United States, or 11.6% of the population, have diabetes. About 1 in 5 adults with diabetes don't know they have the disease. An estimated 97.6 million American adults have prediabetes, which means their blood glucose levels are higher than normal but not high enough to be diagnosed as diabetes.



Many areas of the body can be affected by diabetes. [Learn about diabetes health problems.](#)

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- [Nerve Damage \(Diabetic Neuropathies\)](#)
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- [Low Blood Glucose \(Hypoglycemia\)](#)
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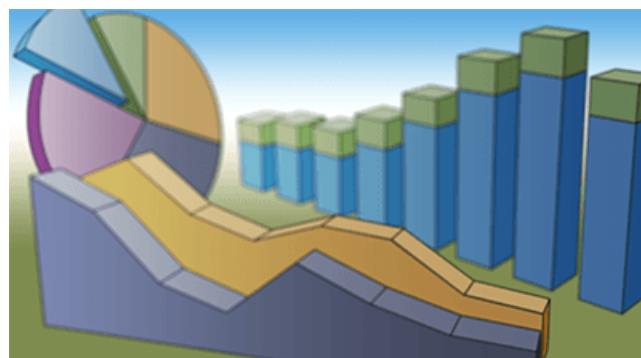
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- [Preventing Type 2 Diabetes](#)
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- [Managing Diabetes](#)
- [Insulin, Medicines, & Other Diabetes Treatments](#)
- [Healthy Living with Diabetes](#)
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Statistics



[Statistics for Diabetes in the United States](#)

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- [Diabetes & Pregnancy](#)
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- [Diabetes Tests & Diagnosis](#)
- [Diabetic Eye Disease](#)
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- [Gestational Diabetes](#)
- [Healthy Living with Diabetes](#)
- [Insulin, Medicines, & Other Diabetes Treatments](#)
- [Insulin Resistance & Prediabetes](#)
- [Low Blood Glucose \(Hypoglycemia\)](#)
- [Managing Diabetes](#)
- [Monogenic Forms of Diabetes: Neonatal Diabetes & MODY](#)
- [Nerve Damage \(Diabetic Neuropathies\)](#)
- [Pancreatic Islet Transplantation](#)
- [Preventing Diabetes Problems](#)
- [Preventing Type 2 Diabetes](#)
- [Risk Factors for Type 2 Diabetes](#)
- [Symptoms & Causes of Diabetes](#)
- [Type 1 Diabetes](#)
- [Type 2 Diabetes](#)
- [What is Diabetes?](#)

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- [Diabetes School Guide](#)
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Clinical Trials



Watch a video of NIDDK Director Dr. Griffin P. Rodgers explaining the importance of participating in clinical trials

Research Discoveries & News

- NIH launches large study to tackle type 2 diabetes in young people [NIH](#)
- Use of metformin in adults with diabetes linked to lower risk of long COVID [NIH](#)
- Bariatric surgery provides long-term blood glucose control, type 2 diabetes remission [NIH](#)
- Celebrating the 50th Anniversary of Diabetes Research Centers

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